01 / THE EXPERIENCE

Enter history. Shape your story.

A character-growth experience rooted in real places, artefacts and historical events.

1. Project concept

PastPort is an interactive character-growth experience set in real historical places and events. Users choose an identity, explore architectural and artefact clues, acquire and use items, interact with story characters, and develop their own path.

We invite visitors to experience history from within: what did the same place mean to people in different positions? During the same historical event, what opportunities did they have, and what choices did they face?

The initial site selection will focus on Türkiye's waqf heritage within the competition's scope. Character stories reveal the connections between buildings, public services and local society. The architecture supports later expansion to other periods and heritage settings.

2. Core experience

Users receive a character background, personal goal and starting items before entering a story organised around a historical event or process. Characters share an era but have different information, resources and routes: a merchant seeks trading relationships, an apprentice seeks work, and an institutional employee must coordinate resources and fulfil responsibilities.

On the map, users explore locations, inspect artefact details and obtain clues. They decide how to use items, respond to people and handle tasks. Choices may develop skills or change reputation, relationships and future opportunities. The system explains these changes and their causes.

Choose an identity → Accept a mission → Explore historical clues → Use items and make choices → Update character state → Unlock places, missions and character paths.

Real history establishes the context and known outcomes; player choices shape fictional personal experiences. Historical facts, evidence-based reconstructions and original fiction are clearly distinguished, with sources provided for historical explanations.

3. Personalisation, interaction and the growth roadmap

Interaction extends beyond AI conversation. Users choose routes, inspect artefacts, collect and use items, and make narrative decisions with persistent consequences. An introduction letter can secure a meeting; a record can verify a claim; limited funds can purchase materials or assistance. Using or handing over an item changes later options.

The system considers character goals, clues, previous choices and feedback. Architecture enthusiasts can explore craft and spatial stories; others can follow relationships. Hints adapt when users struggle, and optional branches shorten when time is limited while preserving the main narrative.

Roadmap: Personal goal → First attempt → Key choice → Changes in skills and relationships → New opportunities → Character path.

Different roles encourage replay: the same place or object means something different to each person. Future friend cooperation can support exchanging information, lending items and completing shared tasks while retaining individual paths. Solo players can complete the full experience.

02 / AN ILLUSTRATIVE CHAPTER

One city. Several lives.

Ankara: “Our Lives in the New Republic”

Purpose of this example: the Ankara chapter illustrates the mechanics and a future expansion setting. It is not a confirmed waqf-eligible pilot for this competition.

4. Historical setting and connected sites

The example follows changes in women’s public participation in Türkiye from 1930 to 1935: municipal electoral rights, parliamentary electoral rights, and the first women entering parliament. Education, culture and personal growth drive the story rather than warfare.

The map connects three historical sites in the same city:
Former Türk Ocağı headquarters, now Ankara Painting and Sculpture Museum: cultural activity and public expression in the Republican period.
Ankara Ethnography Museum: crafts, clothing and everyday-life materials illuminate characters’ family and social backgrounds.
Second Grand National Assembly building, now the Republic Museum: public participation and institutional change.

These sites form a thematic historical route; the proposal does not claim that every fictional event occurred inside them. Real people and events appear through verified sources. Player characters, tasks and dialogue are original fiction.

Four perspectives on a shared historical process

A young woman teacher seeks educational support for students in her hometown and explores her own opportunities for public participation. Possible paths: educator or community organiser.

A craftsperson’s daughter wants recognition for inherited skills and opportunities to earn and develop. Possible paths: craft entrepreneur or cultural documentarian.

A young journalist seeks a first bylined article and must decide whose voice to feature. Possible paths: human-interest or cultural journalist.

A new public-institution employee responds to residents’ needs with limited resources. Possible paths: administrative coordinator or cultural-services worker.

A shared object creates meaningful choices

The character paths intersect around a family-made craft object. Its owner wants to sell it; the teacher wants to borrow it for learning materials; the journalist wants to document its maker; and the employee wants to include it in a cultural project. The object will be defined using authentic collection research.

Players may sell, lend, exhibit collaboratively or retain the object. Each choice changes income, trust, inventory and later missions. A joint exhibition may postpone earnings but create partnerships. Selling may meet an immediate need while requiring others to find alternative teaching or reporting material. Every path can continue; there is no single “correct life”.

Atatürk, Afet İnan and other relevant historical figures may provide context through verified documents, statements and events. The game will not present invented meetings as fact or replace their historical contributions with player actions.

The underlying system stays the same: a shared historical background, locations and clues; distinct personal goals, consequences and growth paths.

03 / IMPACT, DELIVERY & TEAM

From exploration to insight.

A focused first release, supported by an existing adaptive-system foundation.

5. Heritage and tourism value

Each story node connects to a real heritage space, artefact or source. Buildings and objects help users complete tasks and understand people's circumstances, revealing their functions, cultural meaning and social connections.

A proposed operator feedback view will aggregate choices, recurring questions, task difficulties and voluntary feedback. It will identify engaging places and themes, explanations needing expansion or simplification, confusing interactions and content suitable for educational activities or routes. In-game interest and actual visits will be reported separately; clicks will not be treated as visitor popularity.

With site permission and partnerships, future users can begin online, scan a code or check in on site to unlock a chapter, and continue their character journey online. Practical visitor and access information remains available regardless of story progress.

6. Implementation foundation and current progress

Our early GoalCoach adaptive-learning prototype provides a foundation in goal planning, agent interaction and persistent user state. PastPort adapts these capabilities:
Planning: selects subsequent missions from designed branches using goals, resources, relationships and previous choices.
Character and interaction: presents scenes, responds to actions and provides hints and historical information.
Knowledge retrieval: supplies curated, sourced content.
Rules and state: govern item use, major consequences and unlocks, and save character growth.

Core facts and plot milestones are prepared in advance. AI adjusts interaction within defined boundaries. Concept design, the core loop and initial feature planning are complete; PastPort-specific content, maps, inventory and feedback views remain to be built. No site partnership or visitor validation is confirmed.

MVP: one eligible, source-verified site or compact site cluster; one historical event; two roles; five exploration nodes; three key choices; different character paths; one visible task adaptation; and basic feedback summaries. We plan 5–8 playtests to assess goal clarity, perceived consequences, understanding of heritage and willingness to replay another role. Prior-code reuse will follow competition rules and be disclosed separately from new work.

7. Team and responsibilities

Mert Aslan | Cultural Context & Game Experience
A Turkish 42 student born and raised in Istanbul, with a deep connection to local history and culture, enthusiasm for historical narrative games, and current open-source Web3 platform work. Owns local research, Turkish review, character and mission design, and map/game-interface implementation.

Weijia Han | Product Design & Technical Integration
A 42 Heilbronn student with product-operations experience at Bigo and Huawei, language teaching and international coordination at UNODC. Her GoalCoach work connects user goals and product flows with agents and state management. Owns user journeys, progression rules, agent orchestration, backend and frontend integration, and delivery coordination.

Weng Man Cheung | Knowledge Engineering & AI Quality
A 42 Heilbronn student with a translation and lexicography background. Relevant experience includes language corpora, vector databases, retrieval, MCP, database expansion and testing. Owns the historical knowledge base, retrieval, multilingual content preparation, factual consistency and interaction-quality validation.

PastPort makes historical places the setting, artefacts the clues, and visitor choices a path to understanding history.